



Smartphone technology has become increasingly accessible, meaning the once-exclusive flagship-only features have now trickled down to the high-end smartphone segment. This year, high-end smartphones incorporated flagship-grade chipsets, premium hardware, and a plethora of features, making them a more “sensible” purchase in a price-conscious market like India. The winner of this category is one that performs exceedingly well in not just synthetic benchmarks but other aspects such as day-to-day usage, user interface, battery life, and display. Let's find out which phone takes the crown.

Winner and Best Buy: iQOO 9T

The iQOO 9T is the most powerful smartphone you can get your hands on under ₹50K in 2022, period. Powered by the speedy Qualcomm Snapdragon 8+ Gen 1 SoC, this phone is blazing fast no matter what task you throw at it. In fact, it even beat out some of the phones in the premium segment in synthetic

benchmarks. The phone is also capable of sustained performance despite strenuous loads. Additionally, the phone's performance in GPU benchmarks was also excellent. Simply speaking this is one of the most powerful phones in the market in 2022. The phone is lag and stutter free as well when playing demanding games. All of this combined with excellent battery life and a decent enough AMOLED display makes for a fantastic flagship-akin experience that you don't have to spend big on. This level of performance at just ₹50K means that the iQOO 9T not only snags the Digit Zero1 Award win, but also grabs the Best Buy Award for this category!



OnePlus 10T
Price: ₹49,999



Xiaomi 11T Pro
Price: ₹35,999

DIGIT BEST BUY WINNER-2022



iQOO 9T
Price: ₹49,999

Runner-up: OnePlus 10T

While the OnePlus 10T couldn't surpass the iQOO 9T in terms of raw power despite being powered by the same chipset, the OnePlus 10T is no slouch when it comes to performance and can handle everything you throw at it. Its battery life is slightly better than the iQOO 9T with the phone lasting over 15 hours in our 4K video loop test. The phone can also charge to full in merely 34 minutes. Another area where it is slightly ahead of the iQOO 9T is display brightness. We recorded a maximum brightness of 913 nits which is plenty bright in any kind of condition. Despite having these wins, the OnePlus 10T still falls short of the speedy performance offered by the iQOO 9T.

2nd Runner-up: Xiaomi 11T Pro

Housing the capable Qualcomm Snapdragon 888 SoC, the Xiaomi 11T Pro is a great budget choice. For just over ₹35K, the Xiaomi 11T Pro impresses with its consistent and reliable performance. The phone's battery life is excellent as well. We tried Xiaomi's Game Turbo app which you can use to optimise your phone's swipe response, aim accuracy, and more.

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High-end Phone (₹35K to ₹50K)

Giving the flagships a run for their money



iQOO 9T
Price: ₹49,999